HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Because church people hurt me, God must be just like them"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Because church people hurt me, God must be just like them." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was done in God's name?
- ☐ How is God different from them?
- ☐ How does Jesus treat the hurt?
- ☐ Who can I get support from?
- ☐ What do I need from God?
- ☐ What can I read about Jesus?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is compassionate and gracious.
- ☐ He is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He does not break a bruised reed.
- ☐ Those who hurt me did not speak for Him.
- ☐ Jesus sympathizes with my weakness.
- ☐ I can come to God at my own pace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 103:8
  "The LORD is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in loving devotion."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ Isaiah 42:3
  "A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ The real God: Each week, write one trait of God from Scripture that differs from how I was treated.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 103:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord is compassionate and gracious, unlike those who hurt me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "God, All Loving" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name what happened. Write the facts of what was done in God's name.
- ☐ Get support. Tell a counselor or trusted friend; seek legal and safe help if abuse occurred.
- ☐ Read a Gospel. Read Mark slowly and note how Jesus treated hurting people.
- ☐ Pray honestly. Tell God your anger and hurt.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Because church people hurt me, God must be just like them": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	The real God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Because church people hurt me, God must be just like them.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was hurt by people who spoke in Your name. Show me who You really are. Heal my wounds and help me meet You through Jesus, gentle with the broken. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.